

Chapter 89-1

There were too many people coming and going around her. Before Liang Shi could get a closer look, that figure had already disappeared.

The figure vanished so quickly that Liang Shi suspected it was just her imagination.

But when it came to Sun Chengcheng... Liang Shi couldn't be mistaken.

They had spent over three months filming together day and night. As the dual female leads of the drama, their scenes together were absurdly numerous—they filmed shared scenes every single day.

Later during the promotional period, the two of them had the same schedules, and when interviewed by the media, they were always together as a pair.

This was the person Liang Shi had worked with the longest.

That person just now was clearly Sun Chengcheng.

But why would she be here?

Could it be that she wasn't the only one who had transmigrated into a book?

Liang Shi stared in that direction for a long time, until a staff member came over to urge her again, "Teacher Liang, what are you looking at? The makeup artist has been waiting for quite a while."

"Okay, okay." Liang Shi snapped back to her senses, but her mind was unsettled, always feeling like something was about to happen. Facing the staff member's less-than-pleasant attitude, she simply said politely in a low voice, "I'm sorry."

"It's fine." The staff member said, "It's mainly because the director had someone calculate the auspicious time¹. If we miss the timing, we'll all get scolded."

This staff member looked quite young but handled things rather steadily.

She didn't treat Liang Shi differently just because she was a small-time actress who wasn't famous—she had the same attitude toward everyone.

"I understand, thank you." Liang Shi thanked her politely and followed her to the makeup room.

Although Liang Shi was playing the third female lead in the drama, she hadn't debuted and didn't have a management team, so for now she could only share a makeup room with the extras.

Generally speaking, only the first female lead would have a personal rest room that included a makeup area.

If the director could invite a big-name artist for a special appearance, they would also prepare a separate rest room for them.

Liang Shi currently wasn't in the same tier as those people.

This place that looked like a large factory workshop had seven or eight vanity stations, over a dozen mirrors, and was crammed with about a hundred people, most of whom were staff members.

The opening ceremony only required simple makeup and styling—they didn't even need to change clothes. Especially since this was a modern drama, they could just wear their own clothes.

But even if it was simple, it would still be used for promotional photos.

Many paparazzi waited outside early on to get first-hand high-definition material. If the makeup and styling weren't done well and marketing accounts criticized it harshly, it would negatively affect the drama's reception.

If the crew had a good atmosphere, combined with the strong fighting power of the lead actress's fans, it would definitely help build good buzz for the production.

The makeup team that had been with the crew for many years was highly skilled and understood this principle well. They were extremely attentive when doing Liang Shi's makeup.

Even when someone rushed past like a gust of wind, desperate and anxious, the makeup artist's hands remained steady as Mount Tai², not even trembling once while applying eyeshadow on Liang Shi.

Soon, Liang Shi's makeup was done, and the stylist handed her a set of sharp and capable-looking clothes, telling her to go to the fitting room to change.

The clothes looked ordinary at first glance, but actually had many clever details.

Liang Shi could tell almost immediately that these clothes were a new release from a certain brand and must have cost quite a lot.

The production's fitting room was extremely crude—just a space sectioned off with partitions, with a dark curtain drawn across. Every sound from outside could be heard clearly.

Liang Shi accepted this environment with complete composure.

After all, when she first started acting in her previous life, she had endured environments far worse than this.

Even later when she became famous, filming in the desert or in the jungle—those environments were all much harsher than this.

But someone else didn't think so.

Footnotes:

¹ **Auspicious time (吉時):** In Chinese tradition, certain times are considered lucky or favorable for important events. It's common to consult fortune tellers or feng shui masters to calculate the best timing for ceremonies, especially in the entertainment industry where opening ceremonies (開機儀式) mark the start of filming.

² **Steady as Mount Tai (穩如泰山):** A Chinese idiom meaning extremely stable and unshakeable, referencing Mount Tai (Taishan), one of China's Five Great Mountains, which symbolizes stability and permanence.

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Liang Shi had just finished changing when, before she could even pull back the curtain, she heard a girl crying in the adjacent space, sobbing while complaining aggrievedly: "Why is it so dirty here? Wuwuwu, I don't want to change clothes here. I can pay money—can you give me a better place? Wuwu, can't I just build them a changing room? What did I do wrong to deserve this kind of suffering?"

Someone beside her was coaxing her: "My little ancestor¹, weren't you the one who said you wanted to come act? Everyone told you not to come, and now that you're here, you're complaining non-stop."

"I... wuwuwu... I just wanted to be in the same frame as Sister Shuyan. Who knew the filming environment would be this bad?" The girl continued crying.

Liang Shi listened from the side and understood—this was a die-hard fan of Yang Shuyan.

Chasing her idol to the point of becoming an actress herself.

That was quite impressive, actually.

Though she didn't know if this person had invested money to join the production or was here incognito.

The conversation next door continued. Although that pretentious little princess was complaining, she still changed her clothes in that dirty place.

Crying while doing it—it was quite amusing to listen to.

Liang Shi came out after changing and put her clothes into a bag she had prepared in advance. This action made the staff member assigned to her pause in surprise. "Have you filmed before?"

Liang Shi answered: "Just for half a day."

For this world, it was indeed only half a day.

That was also the information the staff member had. The director had specifically told her that this was a newcomer and to pay extra attention, but she hadn't expected Liang Shi's behavior to be nothing like someone who had only filmed for half a day.

After arriving at the set, she didn't look around curiously like a newcomer, wasn't nervous, and even brought her own storage bag to pack away her clothes.

These were all little bits of experience that came from spending a long time with production crews. Especially since she didn't have an assistant, these things were even more commendable.

"That's pretty good." The staff member said calmly.

Then she told Liang Shi to put her clothes in the locker. When she came back around, Liang Shi saw the little princess from next door. Based on her appearance, she should be her CP² in the drama—barely qualifying as the fifth female lead.

The other party didn't have many scenes, basically revolving around her character. She fell in love with a villain and attempted to reform the antagonist with her innocent personality. The villain actually did feel something for her during their time together but firmly pushed her away, so their storyline was a BE³.

It had to be said, the director had quite an eye for casting.

This girl probably wasn't very good at acting, but her real-life image matched the character in the drama very well. It wouldn't be difficult for her to perform—as long as she believed in the story, her acting would be lively.

Seeing her looking at that girl, the staff member took the initiative to introduce: "She's Yan Xi, playing Wu Luxi in the drama. She's also an actress who has a lot of scenes with you. You can go say hello to her later. Building some rapport between you two will make filming feel more natural."

Liang Shi nodded: "Thank you."

The subsequent procedures were similar to what Liang Shi had experienced before—meeting the director, then mingling in the crowd, waiting for the incense offering, ribbon cutting, receiving red envelopes⁴, and group photos.

The girl named Yan Xi stood next to her during the photo because they had many scenes together.

After the photos were done, she went to complain to her agent again, "Why isn't Sister Shuyan here? Isn't she going to appear in this drama? But I only saw Zhao Ying. I'm so angry."

"Miss Yang was only doing a friendship cameo from the start. She definitely wouldn't appear at the opening ceremony." The agent advised, "My little ancestor, please calm down a bit. This isn't like home. If you don't want to be here, we can withdraw at any time."

"No." Yan Xi gripped her mineral water bottle, her words firm: "I must stand in the same position as Sister Shuyan and let her know I'm ten thousand times better than that annoying Zhao Ying!"

Oh ho.

So she was here to poach someone?

Liang Shi didn't have a habit of eavesdropping. It was just that she was hiding in the shade, and before long, the little princess and her agent came over.

The two of them talked without checking if there was anyone around, not even trying to be discreet, openly badmouthing someone.

Liang Shi couldn't exactly cover her ears just to avoid hearing their gossip.

Just as she was about to leave, Zhao Ying came over and handed her a bottle of water. "What's up? Came here to find some peace and quiet?"

Liang Shi smiled and greeted her: "Sister Ying."

When she turned to look at those two people, she found they had left at some point.

Zhao Ying shook her head to herself: "After all this time, I still find them noisy."

Liang Shi smiled: "Then come hide here for some peace and quiet with me."

"Sure." Zhao Ying took a sip of water and stood there with her, looking at the scenery for a while.

There wasn't much to see, really. Late autumn had arrived, autumn leaves were falling, a layer of golden leaves covered the ground, and the trees were becoming bare. Apart from the distant mountains with their overlapping peaks in the suburbs and the azure sky at the far horizon that could lift one's spirits a little, everything else was ordinary.

However, after Zhao Ying finished drinking her water, she asked leisurely: "What did you just overhear?"

Liang Shi: "..."

"Huh?" Liang Shi played dumb.

"Come on, stop pretending." Zhao Ying said: "I didn't come over just now, but I saw you smiling while listening. What did you hear?"

Liang Shi awkwardly touched the tip of her nose.

Zhao Ying spoke first: "The one acting opposite you is Yang Shuyan's..."

She paused, clicked her tongue, and said, "Little childhood sweetheart."

Liang Shi: "?"

This was truly explosive gossip.

Liang Shi had thought it was a die-hard fan who had chased her idol to the production to act, but it turned out to be a real little princess.

"Then..." Liang Shi tentatively asked: "Sister Ying, you and Yang Shuyan..."

Zhao Ying raised an eyebrow: "Want to know?"

Liang Shi: "..."

Looking at Zhao Ying's somewhat dangerous smile, Liang Shi suddenly felt that not knowing was also fine.

But Zhao Ying said straightforwardly: "Exchange secrets."

Liang Shi: "..."

Two seconds later, she unhesitatingly told Zhao Ying what she had just heard, then patted Zhao Ying on the shoulder. "Sister Ying, good luck!"

Her tone was teasing. Zhao Ying glanced at her. "Oh please, she's just a little girl."

The underlying meaning Liang Shi heard was—just a little girl, not worth my effort.

And Zhao Ying said matter-of-factly: "Of course I need to show her what this big sister's charm is like—something she couldn't catch up to even if she tried for eighty years."

Liang Shi: "...?"

Liang Shi was amused by Zhao Ying. "Sister Ying is impressive."

"Stop flattering me." Zhao Ying said: "From now on at the set, I'll pretend not to know you, okay?"

Liang Shi: "Hm?"

Zhao Ying shrugged. "That little girl's family is quite rich. If she gets angry and throws money at the production, and gets you blacklisted⁵ along the way, we'd have to make a fuss, and that would be troublesome."

Liang Shi: "...Alright."

And Liang Shi's sneaky gaze turned toward Zhao Ying.

Zhao Ying unhurriedly took a sip of water. Knowing what Liang Shi wanted to gossip about, after finishing that sip, she tossed the bottle in her hand into the trash can across from them.

The empty water bottle drew a perfect arc through the air. Zhao Ying put both hands in her trench coat pockets, her tone rising, carrying a few parts arrogance and recklessness, as she said airily: "Friends with benefits—"

She drew out the words for a few seconds before curling her lips into a smile. "A relationship that hasn't been made official yet."

Liang Shi: "..."

Do your fans know about this?

Footnotes:

¹ **My little ancestor (祖宗):** A Chinese term of endearment (though sometimes exasperated) used for someone who is being difficult or demanding, often a spoiled child or young person. It literally means "ancestor" but is used sarcastically to suggest the person is being treated like royalty.

² **CP:** Short for "coupling" or "couple pairing," a term borrowed from fan culture referring to a romantic pairing between characters in a story.

³ **BE:** Short for "Bad Ending," a term used in Chinese web novel and fan communities to indicate a storyline that ends tragically or without the couple getting together, as opposed to "HE" (Happy Ending).

⁴ **Red envelopes (紅包):** Traditional Chinese gifts of money in red packets, given during celebrations. In the entertainment industry, it's customary to give red envelopes to cast and crew during opening ceremonies for good luck.

⁵ **Blacklisted (雪藏):** Literally "hidden in snow," this term in the Chinese entertainment industry refers to when a company or powerful person deliberately suppresses an artist's career opportunities, essentially putting them "on ice."

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As it turned out, the fans didn't know.

On the very day that "Mo Guang"¹ bought trending searches to build hype for its opening ceremony, Yang Shuyan and Zhao Ying's fans were still battling three hundred rounds online, going head-to-head with each other.

Their two fan bases had clashed countless times, all fighting over who was the number one among the '95 flowers².'

Both of them had works, popularity, and commercial value. They even had the same number of endorsements—if you had one eyewear brand, I had another; if you had one luxury brand endorsement, I had another; if you were the Asia-Pacific spokesperson, then I was the Europe-Americas one. Anyway, they went head-to-head every time, treating each other as their number one enemy.

And yet... the two of them were fooling around together.

After the opening ceremony ended, Liang Shi looked at the trending topics plaza, her feelings mixed.

But this wasn't the first time she'd seen this kind of thing. Just taking a look was enough.

She was merely passing through the world of gossip.

After the opening ceremony, lunch was boxed meals provided by the production. Many actors, even the sixth and seventh female leads of the production, had brought assistants who collected the meals for them. Only Liang Shi came by herself.

While she was queuing up to get her boxed meal, an uninformed staff member chatted with her, "You're so good-looking, it would be a waste not to act."

Liang Shi smiled awkwardly, "Well, isn't that why I'm here?"

The staff member was embarrassed: "..."

Liang Shi didn't think much of it. After getting her boxed meal, she found a quiet spot, first took a photo and posted it to her Moments³ with the caption: Eating~

But before long, she saw that little princess again, pitifully complaining to her agent once more, "This boxed meal doesn't look appetizing at all. I want to go home. I came here for Sister Shuyan..."

The agent said very readily: "Then let's go back now and eat steak at a five-star restaurant in the city."

Yan Xi immediately shut up, turned around and said: "I think it probably won't be that hard to eat after all."

Liang Shi took a sip of water and immediately sprayed it out, then found herself face-to-face with the little princess who had turned around with her back to her agent.

...

The atmosphere instantly became awkward.

Liang Shi found some tissue to wipe her mouth, pretending she had accidentally sprayed water, and not because she found this little princess too amusing.

But after a while, the little princess came over aggressively with her lunch box and questioned: "Were you laughing at me?"

Liang Shi shook her head: "No."

She had a strong survival instinct when outside and never caused trouble.

Yan Xi stared at her, then suddenly said: "Your eyes are so pretty."

Liang Shi: "..."

Wasn't she supposed to be here to settle accounts with her?

But then Yan Xi sat down next to her, acting quite familiar as she said: "Are you the one acting with me? The one playing that hateful big villain."

Liang Shi: "...Yes."

"Oh." Yan Xi puffed out her cheeks and said: "I'm Yan Xi. I'm playing the one who likes you."

Liang Shi: "...Oh."

"Do you always talk this little?" Yan Xi put her hand to her forehead. "Do all good-looking people talk this little?"

Liang Shi: "...Who else?"

"My Sister Shuyan." Yan Xi said: "Although you're very good-looking, you're still not as good-looking as my Sister Shuyan."

Liang Shi: "...Oh."

Yan Xi chattered on and on with her, but Liang Shi only gave single-word responses. Before long, Yan Xi also found it boring and got straight to the point: "The main thing is, I think your boxed meal looks tastier. Can we swap?"

Liang Shi: "..."

So that's what this was all about?

Liang Shi's boxed meal had just been opened and hadn't been touched yet.

Hearing her say this, and also wanting to get on good terms with this pretentious but genuine little princess, she agreed to swap meals with her.

It just so happened that her meal had green peppers in it. Although this body wasn't allergic to green peppers, she had been allergic to them before, so she had a bit of psychological trauma and didn't dare eat them.

Production boxed meals were usually all the same, but better ones would have two to three varieties, randomly distributed.

Clearly, the "Mo Guang" production belonged to the slightly better category.

So the two happily swapped meals, but Liang Shi asked Yan Xi, "Why didn't your agent follow you over?"

"Who?" Yan Xi was surprised and shook her head: "That's not my agent. That's my wet nurse⁴."

Liang Shi: "...?"

Footnotes:

¹ **Mo Guang (餘光)**: The title of the drama, which literally means "Afterglow" or "Lingering Light."

² **'95 flowers (95花)**: A term in the Chinese entertainment industry referring to popular actresses born in 1995. It's a way of categorizing and comparing actresses by their birth year, with "flowers" indicating top-tier female celebrities of that generation.

³ **Moments (朋友圈)**: WeChat's social media feature similar to Facebook's timeline or Instagram's feed, where users can share photos, text, and updates with their contacts.

⁴ **Wet nurse (奶媽)**: Traditionally, a woman employed to breastfeed and care for another's child. In wealthy or noble families, wet nurses often continued as caregivers throughout childhood. The fact that Yan Xi has a wet nurse indicates she comes from an extremely wealthy, old-money family with traditional household structures.

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There really were so many positions in wealthy households—it had that ancient times feel to it.

Yan Xi was actually fine when eating. Although she kept complaining before eating about how the boxed meal looked unappetizing, when she ate she was very well-mannered—she didn't make any sounds and didn't talk to anyone, just ate quietly.

As for Liang Shi, before eating, she took a photo of her boxed meal and sent it to Xu Qingzhu.

[Teacher Xu, time to eat.]

A moment later, Xu Qingzhu replied: [?]

Liang Shi: [What's wrong?]

Xu Qingzhu: [It's different from what you posted on your Moments.]

Liang Shi: [I swapped with a little sister from the production. She doesn't seem to like eating carrots.]

Xu Qingzhu: [.....]

Liang Shi stared at the screen, not understanding what Xu Qingzhu's ellipsis meant. Just as she was about to send a message to ask, a video call request had already popped up in the chat.

Liang Shi answered it under Yan Xi's curious gaze.

In the video, Xu Qingzhu was sitting in that soft chair in her office, still wearing a light-colored suit. The top button of her white shirt was undone, and you could see the silver necklace she wore around her neck, like stars connected in a line.

Liang Shi asked first: "Have you eaten?"

Xu Qingzhu nodded: "Already ate."

"Why are you only eating now?" Xu Qingzhu asked.

The background on Liang Shi's side showed pine and cypress trees that were still green, not yet shrouded in the grayness of late autumn, without the cold afternoon sun shining down, so visibility was still fairly clear. She answered in a gentle voice: "The opening ceremony ended late."

"Isn't there an opening banquet?" Xu Qingzhu raised an eyebrow while casually flipping open the documents on her desk. She propped her phone in front of her, and the signing pen spun a casual circle between her slender fingers. Her expression was indifferent, her voice still cool and clear, "Why would you be eating boxed meals?"

Liang Shi: "The opening banquet is in the evening. We're eating here at noon, and there's still a script discussion meeting this afternoon."

Xu Qingzhu gave a light nod. "Oh."

Her tone was detached, and after speaking she didn't say anything more, just kept signing documents with a swishing sound as the pen tip scratched across the paper.

Liang Shi didn't know what to do next either... It would be awkward to hang up first, but she also needed to eat.

The atmosphere fell silent. Liang Shi couldn't help but ask: "Is there anything else?"

Xu Qingzhu set the signed documents aside, propped her chin on her hand, and said in an airy tone: "Teacher Liang, aren't you going to show me where you're working?"

Liang Shi: "..."

She turned the camera around, and the screen was suddenly filled with many people. They were shooting on location in the outer suburbs, with people constantly walking back and forth. Even though it was break time, there were still people setting up the scenery. She turned the camera almost three hundred and sixty degrees before switching back to the front-facing camera. "There's nothing much to see, just the wilderness."

"Aren't you filming a modern drama?" Xu Qingzhu said, "Can't you use a CBD¹ or shopping mall?"

Liang Shi explained: "That'll come later. In the early stages, they film in places like this because it's easier for the production to set up scenery."

"Alright." Xu Qingzhu paused, then said rather stiffly: "Beside you."

Liang Shi was confused: "Huh? What?"

"You didn't show me what's beside you just now." Xu Qingzhu said.

Liang Shi: "..."

She glanced at Yan Xi who was sitting beside her quietly eating, and suddenly felt inexplicably guilty for no reason, but still turned the camera over.

Yan Xi was startled, looked up at the camera, then widened her eyes. After swallowing the mouthful of rice in her mouth, she immediately blinked and said: "Awoo, gorgeous beauty!"

Xu Qingzhu & Liang Shi: "..."

"Senior sister, senior sister." Yan Xi immediately said: "Me me me me!"

Xu Qingzhu & Liang Shi: "..."

They had no idea what Yan Xi was saying.

Yan Xi was so excited she was stuttering, but she still persisted in greeting Xu Qingzhu: "Senior sister, I'm Yan Xi from the class of '19². I've seen you before! Gorgeous beauty!"

Xu Qingzhu was momentarily stunned, then raised an eyebrow: "Economics and Trade 1903?"

Yan Xi nodded frantically: "I've listened to your speech before, gorgeous beauty!"

Every sentence she said had to include "gorgeous beauty"—it was quite embarrassing to hear.

But Xu Qingzhu was skeptical: "Then why are you at a production set?"

"I'm here to film, of course." Yan Xi said: "Wuwuwu, I can't believe I actually get to talk to my goddess. I'm so happy."

Liang Shi: "..."

Yan Xi even introduced Liang Shi to Xu Qingzhu: "I'm playing her CP in the drama, the one who really likes her."

Xu Qingzhu: "...And in reality?"

"In reality, I already have someone I like." Yan Xi said: "Although she's very good-looking, I still like gorgeous beauty senior sister more, awoo! Can we add each other on WeChat? I'll just look at your Moments, be a silent lurker, admire your beauty!"

Xu Qingzhu: "...Fine."

Afterward, Liang Shi added Yan Xi on WeChat, then shared Xu Qingzhu's WeChat contact with Yan Xi.

Liang Shi sat there, her feelings extremely mixed.

After finishing lunch, Liang Shi sent a message to Xu Qingzhu: [Teacher Xu is quite charming, huh.]

Xu Qingzhu: [...Teacher Liang is also getting along quite well with her CP.]

Footnotes:

¹ **CBD:** Central Business District—the commercial and business center of a city, typically featuring modern skyscrapers and office buildings.

² **Class of '19 (19級):** In Chinese universities, students are identified by their enrollment year. "19級" refers to students who enrolled in 2019, making Yan Xi a junior to Xu Qingzhu at the same university (Qingyi University).

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The script discussion meeting was held in the afternoon, which was basically to sort through the script logic and character logic.

It mainly focused on the earlier parts of the story. A TV drama with dozens of episodes naturally couldn't cover everything at once.

This director was actually quite fast—the meeting went until past six in the evening, when the sky was nearly dark.

The opening banquet was held in the city center, and everyone drove there.

The dining location wasn't far from Xu Qingzhu's company. Liang Shi thought she could still go home afterward, but during the meal, the director said he had booked hotel rooms for all the actors. They needed to continue the script discussion meeting tomorrow morning, so it was best if everyone who could stay would stay.

Liang Shi secretly asked Zhao Ying if she was going home. Zhao Ying shrugged, "After filming starts, I basically stay at hotels."

"Besides, we'll be drinking later. By the time we finish eating and drinking, it won't be early anymore, and the road back won't be very safe." Zhao Ying said, "A hotel is more convenient."

The other female lead of the production, Shu Yi, also wasn't leaving. Under these circumstances, it would seem a bit out of place for Liang Shi to leave.

Liang Shi could only send a message to Xu Qingzhu saying she wouldn't be coming home tonight.

The place the director chose was a venue the production often came to for group meals. They frequently hosted these large group dinners and were already very experienced.

Over a hundred people from the production were there. After Liang Shi arrived, she followed along and had a few drinks, not daring to drink too much. Then, finding it stuffy inside, she went to the corridor to get some air.

When she was about to go back, she bumped into a woman who was somewhat drunk. The other party was wearing a black tank top paired with black high-waisted jeans, with something sparkly on the belt, and medium-length hair draped over her shoulders.

Liang Shi steadied her and exclaimed: "Careful."

The other party looked up, and both were surprised: "It's you?"

Liang Shi let go of the hand that was supporting her and smiled: "What a coincidence."

Gu Yixue also curved her lips: "Quite a coincidence indeed."

She had drunk too much, her face flushed red. "Why are you here? Are you an actress?"

Liang Shi nodded: "Mm, the production just started filming."

"What a coincidence." Gu Yixue smiled: "We just finished filming."

The two had only met once before and weren't familiar with each other, but when they ran into each other, they would casually chat a bit. Gu Yixue felt around in her pocket and pulled out a metallic lighter. "Here, I said I'd give you a lighter next time we met."

Liang Shi: "..."

She accepted it without any politeness. "Then thanks."

The body of the metal lighter was cold to the touch, with the character "风"¹ engraved in the bottom right corner.

Liang Shi's fingers traced over that character. Gu Yixue waved at her casually, "I'm off."

Not far away, someone called out: "Director, are you drunk?!"

Gu Yixue chuckled lightly, "Get lost."

Every frown and smile of hers was filled with allure.

She walked forward, but her footing was unsteady and she nearly fell. Liang Shi hurriedly reached out to catch her.

However, this moment was witnessed by Lumi, who happened to be coming this way for a classmate reunion. She took out her phone and immediately snapped a photo, then without hesitation sent it to her boss Xu Qingzhu: [Director Xu, although... but... I think you should still know...]

Xu Qingzhu, who was at home alone bored and watching TV, opened her phone: [...?]

Footnotes:

¹ 风 (fēng): The Chinese character meaning "wind." This appears to be part of Gu Yixue's name or a personal symbol, as her name 沂雪 (Yixue) combined with 风 (wind) could be a stylistic choice. It may also relate to her artistic persona as a director.